

Incredible migration

The monarchs are unusual butterflies. When the cold winter sets in they undertake an incredible journey. They travel from Canada to the fine weather in California, USA, and Mexico, and can cover 130 km (80 miles) in a day.



Trees are often covered in monarch butterflies as they rest.

Tasty titbits

Caterpillars can make tasty snacks for some animals, so they have cunning ways of fooling their enemies.



Puss moth

caterpillar: it rears its colourful head when threatened.



Elephant hawk-moth

caterpillar: it can change the shape of its body to look like a snake.



Postman

caterpillar: it is covered in long spines.

Caterpillars spend most of their time eating.



Eating

Butterflies and moths hatch as caterpillars, which eat in a completely different way to the adults.

Butterflies keep their tongues rolled into a coil until they want to eat. They then unroll it and use it like a straw.

Hungry caterpillar

Caterpillars have strong jaws, which they use to chew leaves. When they become butterflies their mouthparts are different – instead they have a long tongue, or proboscis, which they use to sip liquid.

Tongue, or proboscis

Turn and learn

How caterpillars change into butterflies:
pp. 108-109

